

Strauss: A very simple shader mostly used to simulate plastic or metal surfaces.

Translucent: Translucent shading is similar to Blinn shading, but it also lets you specify translucency. A translucent object allows light to pass through, and also scatters light within the object. You can use translucency to simulate frosted and etched glass.

Raytrace Material

The Raytrace material uses 3ds Max's raytracer to render its surfaces. Raytracing works by tracing rays of light through the scene, which gives accurate reflections and refractions. This makes it ideal for transparent or reflective surfaces, such as glass or water.

Matte/Shadow Material

The Matte/Shadow material is a special-purpose material used when compositing a 3D scene against existing images or footage. Objects textured with the Matte/Shadow material take on the look of the background image. These objects, however, can cast shadows and create reflections on the matte material, so that they can be used to integrate 3D objects.

Multi/Sub-Object Material

This is not really a material, but a material that holds other materials. Each material has a list of sub-materials, which can be applied to different parts of an object. The parts of the polygon to be textured are configured in the Edit Poly or Edit Mesh modifier. In the polygon rollout, a polygon or group of polygons can be assigned an ID that corresponds to a sub-material slot. These polygons will be textured with the corresponding material.

Architectural Material

The Architectural materials are a robust set of materials that allow you to easily create surfaces used in architectural applications. These include glass, fabric, masonry, and metal, among others. Architectural materials are based on physical properties, so they provide high realism when rendered by using photo metrics and radiosity, allowing architects and designers to create lighting studies with a high degree of accuracy. Architectural materials, however, don't work well with the standard renderer or the light tracer.

Ink 'n Paint Material

The Ink 'n Paint material renders objects with a limited colour palette along